

an absolute minimum, but obviously there could have been any number of further intervening generations, which would place the archetype much earlier.) But what are the implications of perfect representatives of a family in the tenth century in four diverse locations? How could there be **perfect** copies of *anything* in the 10th century?? That there were four perfect (virtually) representatives of the **f³⁵** archetype in diverse locations in the 10th century is a fact. That they were separated from that archetype by at least one intervening generation is also a fact. So how can we explain them?

Did someone concoct the **f³⁵** archetype in the 8th century? Who? Why? And how could it spread around the Mediterranean world? There are **f³⁵** MSS all over the place—Jerusalem, Sinai, Athens, Constantinople, Trikala, Kalavryta, Ochrida, Patmos, Karditsa, Rome, Sparta, Meteora, Venedig, Lesbos, and most monasteries on Mt. Athos (that represented different ‘denominations’), etc. [If there were six monasteries on Cyprus—one Anglican, one Assembly of God, one Baptist, one Church of Christ, one Methodist and one Presbyterian—to what extent would they compare notes? Has human nature changed?] But the Byzantine bulk (**K^x**) controlled at least 60% of the transmissional stream (**f³⁵** = about 16%); how could something concocted in the 8th century spread so far, so fast, and in such purity? How did it inspire such loyalty? Everything that we know about the history of the transmission of the Text answers that it could not and did not. It is simply impossible that **f³⁵** could have been ‘concocted’ at any point subsequent to the 4th century. The loyalty with which **f³⁵** was copied, the level of loyalty for **f³⁵** being much higher than that for any other line of transmission, indicates that it was never ‘concocted’—it goes back to the Original.

However, although **f³⁵** has been demonstrated to be independent of **K^x** (Byzantine bulk), they are really very close and must have a common source. (I would say that **K^x** represents a departure from **f³⁵**, that **f³⁵** is therefore older.) In the General Epistles **f³⁵** does not differ from the H-F Majority Text all that much. For instance, in James **f³⁵** differs from H-F nineteen times, only two of which affect the meaning (not seriously). If **f³⁵** and **K^x** have a common source, but **f³⁵** is independent of **K^x**, then **f³⁵** must be at least as old as **K^x**—Q.E.D. [*quod erat demonstrandum*, for those who read Latin; “which was to be proved”, for the rest of us; and in yet plainer English, “the point to be proved has been proved”].

Further, if **f³⁵** is independent of all other known lines of transmission, then it must hark back to the Autographs. If it was created out of existing materials at some point down the line, then it is dependent on those materials and it should be possible to demonstrate that dependence. So far as I